



Bulletin

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GOVERNANCE · FINANCE · ICT INFRASTRUCTURE · DPI · TECHNOLOGY · CAPACITY · INCLUSION · DATA · GEOPOLITICS

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

- **South Africa's USAASA Publishes Framework for Universal Service and Access Fund** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's universal service agency published the manual for its fund, a framework for how subsidies and project grants under the Electronic Communications Act are to be run. Procedures for applying and for payment are to follow separately. *Also under [Access to services](#) and [Connectivity](#).*

- **Only 15% of Mozambicans can afford mobile internet access** — Club of Mozambique, 7 October 2026

MOZAMBIQUE

A proposed Internet for All strategy for Mozambique, to be implemented by the communications regulator with targets to 2030, was presented in Maputo. A partner organisation said only 15% of the population can afford to keep a mobile data package, against about 5.6 million mobile internet subscribers in some 36 million people. *Also under [Digital divides](#) and [Connectivity](#).*

- **Minister Savannah vows to continue advocating for women In tech** — Independent News Eswatini, 7 October 2026 ESWATINI GAMBIA

Eswatini's ICT ministry and Smart Africa opened a workshop on 7 October to develop and pilot gender impact assessment tools for digital policy, with Eswatini and The Gambia as pilot countries. Three instruments are to be tested on selected digital policies before validation. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

- **Gender impact tool targets the digital divide facing women** — FinGuard Magazine, 7 October 2026 ESWATINI

GAMBIA

A magazine account of the same Eswatini pilot of Smart Africa's gender impact assessment framework, which is meant to test whether digital programmes narrow the divide facing women. It names the tools differently from the ministry's account. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

- **Gender checks proposed for digital policies** — Times of Eswatini, 7 October 2026 ESWATINI GAMBIA

Eswatini's ICT minister, opening the gender impact assessment workshop in Mbabane, said the government wants such assessments built into digital policies and programmes before they are implemented. *Also under [Digital divides](#).*

- **AI takes the bench before the rulebook is ready** — ITWeb South Africa, 7 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

South Africa's judiciary has not finalised its draft policy on artificial intelligence, which a judges' conference in July sent to a steering committee to complete. Judges have meanwhile used a chatbot in rulings, in one case to reconcile payments and in another to test fabricated citations. *Also under [AI](#).*

Legislation and regulation

- **SIM deactivation now backed by law, CA says** — Daily Nation, 7 October 2026

KENYA

Kenya's communications regulator told a National Assembly committee that SIM deactivation and number recycling now run under its 2026 procedures: notice to the subscriber's contact after three months' inactivity, a public notice and status check before recycling after six, and whitelisting for subscribers who are sick, imprisoned or deceased. It was answering a petition against the largest operator's recycling. *Also under [Digital Identity and CRVS](#) and [Data protection](#).*

- **Govt steps up safety against cybersecurity and data privacy** — The Standard, 7 October 2026

KENYA

Kenya's ICT minister told the Senate that the national incident response centre's digital forensics laboratory has received more than 200 investigation requests, most involving online abuse. A working group on online safety, a national referral directory and a review of gaps in the law have been agreed. *Also under [Cybersecurity](#) and [Data protection](#).*

- **Egypt: Personal Data Protection Law Update** — Baker McKenzie, 7 October 2026

EGYPT

Egypt's Personal Data Protection Center opened its electronic portal for accreditation, licence and permit applications in early October, weeks before the data-protection law's compliance grace period ends on 31 October 2026, on a law firm's account. Applying needs a Digital Egypt login tied to an Egyptian national ID, so foreign controllers and processors must act through an authorised local representative. *Also under [Data protection](#).*

Data protection

- **TikToker charged over alleged fake news, data disclosure** — New Vision, 7 October 2026

UGANDA

A TikTok user was charged in Kampala on 6 October with unlawfully obtaining and disclosing personal data under Uganda's data protection act, and with publishing false news, over a photograph and video of a State House employee. He denied the charges; the case returns on 19 October.

- **SIM deactivation now backed by law, CA says** — Daily Nation, 7 October 2026

KENYA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

- **Govt steps up safety against cybersecurity and data privacy** — The Standard, 7 October 2026

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- **Egypt: Personal Data Protection Law Update** — Baker McKenzie, 7 October 2026

EGYPT

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

Regional collaboration

- **Metical poderá ser usado em pagamentos na SADC a partir de Janeiro de 2027** — Times de Todos, 7 October 2026

MOZAMBIQUE

SOUTHERN AFRICA

Mozambique's central bank governor said the metical could be used for payments between Southern African countries from January 2027 through the regional real-time settlement system, which is hosted at South Africa's central bank. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

- **CEMAC : la BEAC annonce la création d'un marché secondaire de la dette** — Défis Actuels / News du Cameroun, 7 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

Closing a bankers' meeting at Bangui on 3 October, the governor of the Central African regional central bank announced a secondary market for debt, with other work to modernise payments and deepen the regional financial market. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#), [Digital sovereignty](#) and [Data Storage](#).*

- **AfricaNenda trains Journalists On Inclusive Instant Digital Payments** — News Agency of Nigeria, 7 October 2026 AFRICA

AfricaNenda says its payments regulation initiative with the African Union Commission has moved to implementation after a feasibility study found a harmonised framework workable. The study names eight priority areas, licence passporting and interoperability standards among them, and a phased roadmap. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#) and [Training and skills](#).*

- **African Fintechs Seek One Licence For Continent-Wide Expansion** — Digitnomics, 7 October 2026 AFRICA

African payment companies are pressing for licence passporting, under which a firm licensed in one country could operate in others without starting again. It is part of the African Union Commission's work with AfricaNenda on cross-border payment rules. *Also under [Digital Payments and Fintech](#).*

Standards

- **Digital Public Goods Alliance launches DPGs for DPI Collection** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI) - IIIT Bangalore, 7 October 2026 GLOBAL

The Digital Public Goods Alliance launched a collection of 18 digital public goods for digital public infrastructure on 7 October at a regional forum in Santo Domingo. Each was assessed against technical criteria across identity, payments, data exchange, registries and trust systems. *Also under [Other GovTech](#) and [e-Gov](#).*

Public debate and participation in policymaking

- **Obidients Want INEC To Abandon AI Results Verification Plan** — KapitalFM 92.9 Abuja, 7 October 2026 NIGERIA

A Nigerian opposition movement called on the electoral commission to abandon its planned use of AI to verify the 2027 election results until the governance framework is published. It demands independent verification, traceability from polling unit to final collation and publication of the result forms. *Also under [AI](#).*

Finance

MoUs and other agreements

- **Senegal Signs Deal to Launch Digital Equipment Assembly Complex in Diamniadio** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026 SENEGAL

Senegal's digital minister signed a memorandum on 6 October with an African investment council and an Indian technology company under the Senegal Digital Factory phase of the national digital strategy. A digital equipment assembly complex at Diamniadio is its centrepiece. *Also under [ICT Industry](#) and [Digital sovereignty](#).*

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

- **Télécommunications : MAGT et l'État signent une convention stratégique** — L'Union - Sonapresse, 7 October 2026 GABON

Gabon's incumbent operator and the digital-economy ministry signed a convention at Mouila on 6 October ceding to the State the 196 km Fougamou-Mouila fibre section the operator pre-financed and built, with two technical centres. It is the first segment of the first phase of the national backbone extension.
- **South Africa's USAASA Publishes Framework for Universal Service and Access Fund** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).
- **Only 15% of Mozambicans can afford mobile internet access** — Club of Mozambique, 7 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE

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Data Storage

- **Cloud, données et IA : Mauritius Telecom et AWS mobilisent les entreprises publiques** — L'Express (Maurice), 7 October 2026 MAURITIUS

Mauritius Telecom and Amazon Web Services brought more than 125 delegates from state-owned enterprises to an executive workshop on cloud, data and AI at Ebene on 6 October, to identify uses in public services. *Also under [AI](#) and [Training and skills](#).*
- **CEMAC : la BEAC annonce la création d'un marché secondaire de la dette** — Défis Actuels / News du Cameroun, 7 October 2026 CENTRAL AFRICA

Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Cybersecurity

- **Uganda Launches Child Online Protection Campaign to Promote Safer Internet Use** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026 UGANDA

Uganda's communications regulator launched a child online protection campaign at a Kampala secondary school, to teach children to recognise and manage online risks. The ICT permanent secretary called on parents, schools, technology companies and government to share the work. *Also under [Literacy](#).*
- **Rwanda and Slovakia explore cooperation on AI, cybersecurity and space** — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026 RWANDA

Rwanda's ICT minister received Slovakia's ambassador on 6 October to discuss widening the two countries' cybersecurity cooperation to artificial intelligence, space and digital skills. Nothing was signed. *Also under [AI](#).*
- **Djibouti et l'OIF ciblent les métiers de la cybersécurité pour insérer la jeunesse** — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026 DJIBOUTI

The Francophonie organisation and Djibouti's education and vocational training ministry signed an agreement to train 200 young people in web and mobile development and in network infrastructure and cybersecurity. It extends a programme that the organisation says has trained 200 since 2022. *Also under [Training and skills](#).*

- **Govt steps up safety against cybersecurity and data privacy** — The Standard, 7 October 2026

KENYA

Summarised under [Legislation and regulation](#).

DPI

Digital Identity and CRVS

- **SIM deactivation now backed by law, CA says** — Daily Nation, 7 October 2026

KENYA

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Digital Payments and Fintech

- **M-KOPA acquires Finnish device-locking company KilpiTek Oy for \$8 million** — TechCabal, 7 October 2026

KENYA

M-KOPA's financial statements show it completed the US\$8m acquisition of a Finnish device-locking software company on 26 March 2026, US\$2.67m of it in cash. The purchase brings in-house the technology that restricts financed smartphones when customers fall behind. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

- **Acquired by Nigerian group Zedcrest, fintech Leatherback becomes Foren** — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026

NIGERIA

The cross-border payments company Leatherback has renamed itself Foren, after its acquisition by a Nigerian financial group in July 2026. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

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- **African Fintechs Seek One Licence For Continent-Wide Expansion** — Digitnomics, 7 October 2026

AFRICA

Summarised under [Regional collaboration](#).

Registries

- **Nigerian company Milsat Technologies powers new National Digital Postcode** — Tech Review Africa, 7 October 2026

NIGERIA

Nigeria's communications minister named a Nigerian company as the builder of the technology behind the new national digital postcode, saying it moved from a 2023 pilot to the national system. *Also under [ICT Industry](#).*

Other GovTech and e-Gov

- **Digital Public Goods Alliance launches DPGs for DPI Collection** — Centre for Digital Public Infrastructure (CDPI) - IIIT Bangalore, 7 October 2026

GLOBAL

Summarised under [Standards](#).

Technology

AI

- [Côte d'Ivoire, TerraKora AI sign agreement to enhance ecosystem monitoring](#) — Tech Review Africa, 7 October 2026

CÔTE D'IVOIRE

Cote d'Ivoire's environment ministry signed a framework memorandum with an Ivorian company to map land use, monitor environmental change and estimate carbon stocks from satellite data, field observation and AI. The 2021 forest inventory put forest cover at 2.97 million hectares, 9.2% of the territory. *Also under [Use of satellite data](#).*

- [Rwanda and Slovakia explore cooperation on AI, cybersecurity and space](#) — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026

RWANDA

Summarised under [Cybersecurity](#).

- [Obidients Want INEC To Abandon AI Results Verification Plan](#) — KapitalFM 92.9 Abuja, 7 October 2026

NIGERIA

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- [Cloud, données et IA : Mauritius Telecom et AWS mobilisent les entreprises publiques](#) — L'Express (Maurice), 7 October 2026

MAURITIUS

Summarised under [Data Storage](#).

- [AI takes the bench before the rulebook is ready](#) — ITWeb South Africa, 7 October 2026

SOUTH AFRICA

Summarised under [Strategies, plans and policies](#).

ICT Industry

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SENEGAL

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NIGERIA

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- [Acquired by Nigerian group Zedcrest, fintech Leatherback becomes Foren](#) — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026

NIGERIA

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Capacity

Literacy

- [Uganda Launches Child Online Protection Campaign to Promote Safer Internet Use](#) — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026 UGANDA
Summarised under [Cybersecurity](#).

Training and skills

- [10th AfriGEO Symposium opens in Abuja, with NASRDA Chief urging data-driven decisions](#) — Tech Review Africa, 7 October 2026 NIGERIA AFRICA
The tenth symposium of Africa's earth observation community opened at Nigeria's space centre in Abuja. The head of the Nigerian space agency urged participants to turn data into intelligence that feeds decisions. *Also under [Use of satellite data](#) and [Open data](#).*
- [Djibouti et l'OIF ciblent les métiers de la cybersécurité pour insérer la jeunesse](#) — wearetech.africa, 7 October 2026 DJIBOUTI
Summarised under [Cybersecurity](#).
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Inclusion

Access to services

- [South Africa's USAASA Publishes Framework for Universal Service and Access Fund](#) — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026 SOUTH AFRICA
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Digital divides

- [Only 15% of Mozambicans can afford mobile internet access](#) — Club of Mozambique, 7 October 2026 MOZAMBIQUE
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ESWATINI

GAMBIA

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Data

Open data

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AFRICA

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NIGERIA

AFRICA

Summarised under [Training and skills](#).

Geopolitics

China activities

- **Gabon : Huawei se positionne sur les chantiers de la souveraineté numérique** — GabonReview, 7 October 2026

GABON

Huawei's Gabon subsidiary was received by the vice-president of the government on 6 October and restated its offer to support the state's digital transformation, in infrastructure, energy, cybersecurity and skills transfer. No agreement is reported. *Also under [Digital sovereignty](#).*

Digital sovereignty

- **Senegal Signs Deal to Launch Digital Equipment Assembly Complex in Diamniadio** — Tech Africa News, 7 October 2026

SENEGAL

Summarised under [MoUs and other agreements](#).

- **Gabon : Huawei se positionne sur les chantiers de la souveraineté numérique** — GabonReview, 7 October 2026

GABON

Summarised under [China activities](#).

- **CEMAC : la BEAC annonce la création d'un marché secondaire de la dette** — Défis Actuels / News du Cameroun, 7 October 2026

CENTRAL AFRICA

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ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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This bulletin is produced automatically at the end of each data collection sweep but only includes items published on the day cited in the edition, and the previous day. Items published in the last month can be found on the [country pages](#). The links to all items stored in the corpus can be found in the [catalogue](#).

Bulletins are kept for a week — the last week's editions are listed above, each at its own dated address — and are then deleted. Older material is in the country pages and the monthly reports.